3.5.5 Negative feedback helps maintain an optimal internal state in the context of a dynamic equilibrium. Positive feedback also occurs.

Principles	Negative feedback restores systems to their original level. The possession of separate mechanisms involving negative feedback controls departures in different directions from the original state, giving a greater degree of control. Positive feedback results in greater departures from the original levels. Positive feedback is often associated with a breakdown of control systems, e.g. in temperature control. **Candidates should be able to** interpret diagrammatic representations of negative and positive feedback.
Control of mammalian oestrus	The mammalian oestrous cycle is controlled by FSH, LH, progesterone and oestrogen. The secretion of FSH, LH, progesterone and oestrogen is controlled by interacting negative and positive feedback loops. **Candidates should be able to** interpret graphs showing the blood concentrations of FSH, LH, progesterone and oestrogen during a given oestrous cycle. Changes in the ovary and uterus lining are **not** required.